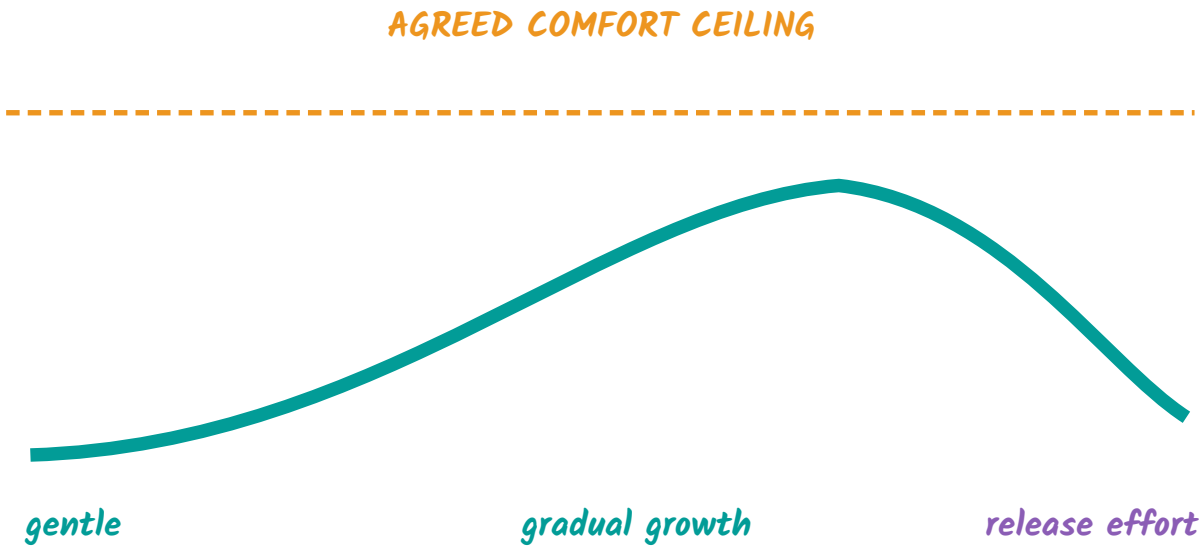
ACTIVITY 085

Crescendo With a Ceiling

Expression & Interpretation

6 minutes / Four-beat sustained note or short phrase.

Increase intensity gradually within a comfortable volume range.



Agree the comfortable ceiling first. Grow gradually and remain below it.

1. Agree a comfortable upper volume before starting; this is the ceiling, not a challenge.
2. Begin gently and increase a little over four beats without exceeding that level.
3. Repeat with a four-beat decrease, then use the shape in repertoire.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The change is gradual and stops before the tone becomes forced.

COMMON TRAP

Letting a crescendo become a loudness challenge.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a two-level change or let singers stay at medium while listening.